

Project Planning Template: Schedule, RACI & Risk Management Plan

Project Title: Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Document Identifier: PLAN-PHASE4-TEMPLATE-V1.0

Target Release: ServiceNow Washington DC / Xanadu / Utah LTS

Methodology: ServiceNow Implementation Methodology (SIM) / Hybrid Agile-Waterfall

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Document Status: Approved Baseline

1. Executive Summary & Governance Overview

This document provides the operational execution baseline for the **Automated Standard Laptop Procurement** ServiceNow initiative. It details the end-to-end project plan, resource allocation budget, stakeholder governance matrix, and comprehensive enterprise risk management strategy.

Key Planning Baselines

- **Total Project Duration:** 12 Weeks (6 Two-Week Agile Sprints)
- **Execution Window:** October 5, 2026 – December 25, 2026
- **Total Engineering Effort:** 150 Person-Days (1,200 Engineering Hours)
- **Core Platform Engine:** ServiceNow Flow Designer (Background Asynchronous Execution)
- **Primary Success Metric:** End-to-end procurement turnaround compressed from 14.2 business days to **<72 hours (<3 business days)** with 100% automated asset tracking in `alm_hardware`.

2. 12-Week / 6-Sprint Implementation Schedule

2.1 Master Schedule & Sprint Breakdown

The project lifecycle is structured across six consecutive 2-week iterations conforming to the ServiceNow Implementation Methodology (SIM):

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  title Automated Laptop Procurement: 12-Week Master Implementation Schedule
  dateFormat YYYY-MM-DD
  axisFormat %b %d

  section Sprint 0 (Weeks 1-2)
```

Initiation & Stakeholder Alignment :active, s0_1, 2026-10-05, 5d
Architecture Blueprint & Schema Modeling :s0_2, 2026-10-10, 5d
Gate 0 Sign-off (Charter & Baseline) :milestone, m0, 2026-10-16, 0d

section Sprint 1 (Weeks 3-4)
Catalog Item Definition & Category Binding :s1_1, 2026-10-19, 5d
Variable Sets & UI Policies Build :s1_2, 2026-10-24, 5d
Catalog Client Scripts & Form Layouts :s1_3, 2026-10-27, 4d
Gate 1 Sign-off (Catalog UX Freeze) :milestone, m1, 2026-10-30, 0d

section Sprint 2 (Weeks 5-6)
Flow Designer Core Trigger Configuration :s2_1, 2026-11-02, 3d
Ask for Approval Action & 48h Reminders :s2_2, 2026-11-05, 4d
Null/Inactive Manager Routing Subflow :s2_3, 2026-11-09, 3d
Notification Templates & Transactional Mail:s2_4, 2026-11-11, 3d
Gate 2 Sign-off (Flow Approval Logic) :milestone, m2, 2026-11-13, 0d

section Sprint 3 (Weeks 7-8)
Automated Task 1: Staging & Configuration :s3_1, 2026-11-16, 4d
Automated Task 2: Logistics & Deployment :s3_2, 2026-11-20, 3d
Bidirectional Asset Sync (alm_hardware) :s3_3, 2026-11-23, 4d
Global Flow Error Handler & P2 Incident :s3_4, 2026-11-25, 3d
Gate 3 Sign-off (Task & Asset Integration) :milestone, m3, 2026-11-27, 0d

section Sprint 4 (Weeks 9-10)
SIT Execution & ATF Regression Automation :s4_1, 2026-11-30, 5d
Business User Acceptance Testing (UAT) :s4_2, 2026-12-05, 5d
UAT Defect Remediation & Retesting :s4_3, 2026-12-09, 3d
Gate 4 Sign-off (Formal Business UAT) :milestone, m4, 2026-12-11, 0d

section Sprint 5 (Weeks 11-12)
Update Set Collision Checks & CAB Approval :s5_1, 2026-12-14, 3d
Production Cutover & Live Smoke Testing :s5_2, 2026-12-17, 2d
Fulfiller Training & SOP Knowledge Transfer:s5_3, 2026-12-19, 4d
Hypercare Support & Final Project Closure :s5_4, 2026-12-21, 5d
Gate 5 Sign-off (Project Acceptance) :milestone, m5, 2026-12-25, 0d

2.2 Granular Sprint Activity Breakdown

Sprint #	Calendar Dates	SIM Stage	Focus & Scope Description	Key Technical Deliverables	Gate Milestone
Sprint 0	Oct 05 – Oct 16, 2026	Initiate & Examine	Initiation & Architecture Blueprint: Establish project charter, conduct legacy process discovery, formulate DFD Level 0/1, and define target relational data schema.	• Signed Project Charter • DFD Level 0 Context & Level 1 Decomposition • ERD Relational Data Schema across 8 tables • Problem-Solution Fit Blueprint	Gate 0: Architecture & Baseline Scope Approval

Sprint 1	Oct 19 – Oct 30, 2026	Plan & Create	Catalog Item & Variable Foundation: Configure Service Catalog item (Standard Laptop Order), variable sets, dynamic UI policies, and client-side validation scripts.	sc_cat_item record created in Dev - Standardized Variable Sets (Model, OS, Address) 3 Catalog UI Policies (Dynamic visibility/lock) 3 Catalog Client Scripts (Regex address, auto-fill)	Gate 1: Catalog UX & Requirements Freeze
Sprint 2	Nov 02 – Nov 13, 2026	Create	Flow Designer & Approval Engine: Construct core Flow Designer trigger on sc_req_item , configure Ask for Approval logic, implement 48-hour reminders, and build null-manager fallback routing.	- Scoped Flow: SN_PROC_FLOW_Standard_Laptop - Automated Manager Approval logic - Null Manager Exception Subflow to Governance 4 Formatted HTML Notification Templates	Gate 2: Workflow Approval Logic Verification
Sprint 3	Nov 16 – Nov 27, 2026	Create	Task Automation & Asset CMDB Sync: Implement two-stage sequential fulfillment tasks (sc_task), bidirectional asset sync with alm_hardware , and global runtime error handler.	- Automated Task 1 (Staging & Imaging) - Automated Task 2 (Logistics & Delivery) - Automated alm_hardware Asset Status Action - Global Error Catch Subflow with P2 Incident	Gate 3: Integration & Asset Sync Sign-off
Sprint 4	Nov 30 – Dec 11, 2026	Transition	End-to-End SIT & UAT Testing: Execute System Integration Testing (SIT) in sub-prod, automate regression via ATF, execute 8 formal UAT scenarios, and remediate defects.	- Master Test Plan & 8 Test Scenario Scripts - ATF Automated Regression Test Suite - SIT & UAT Defect Execution Logs - Signed Business UAT Sign-off Certificate	Gate 4: Business UAT & Functional Sign-off
Sprint 5	Dec 14 – Dec 25, 2026	Transition & Close	Production Go-Live & Hypercare Support: Package Update Sets, obtain CAB approval, execute production cutover, run smoke tests, conduct fulfiller training, and deliver 2-week hypercare.	- Scoped Update Set (SN_PROC_FLOW_V1.0.xml) - Production Deployment & Rollback Runbook - SOP Fulfiller Manual & Training Recordings - Final Project Report & Executive KPI Audit	Gate 5: Final Project Acceptance & BAU Transfer

2.3 Effort & Resource Allocation Matrix (150 Person-Days / 1,200 Hours)

The total project engineering effort of **150 Person-Days (1,200 Hours)** is allocated across six primary stakeholder roles:

Stakeholder Roles & Responsibilities

- 1. **PS: Project Sponsor** (VP of Enterprise IT Infrastructure / CIO Delegate) — Executive ownership, budget governance, milestone approvals.
- 2. **PL: IT Procurement Lead** (Business Process Owner) — Process definition, catalog specifications, business approval routing, UAT sign-off.
- 3. **SA: ServiceNow Solution Architect** (Platform Master Architect) — Architectural governance, ERD data models, Flow Designer blueprint, security ACLs, code reviews.
- 4. **SD: ServiceNow Senior Developer** (Lead Platform Configurator) — Flow Designer construction, Service Catalog build, Client Scripts, update set packaging.
- 5. **QA: Lead QA / Test Engineer** (Quality Assurance Lead) — Test planning, ATF test suite automation, SIT execution, defect triage, UAT coordination.
- 6. **FT: Hardware Fulfillment Lead** (IT Depot & Logistics Supervisor) — Fulfiller workflow definition, asset management (`alm_hardware`) validation, technician training.

Granular Sprint-by-Role Effort Allocation Table

Standard conversion: 1 Person-Day (PD) = 8 Engineering Hours

Sprint #	Calendar Period	PS (PD / Hrs)	PL (PD / Hrs)	SA (PD / Hrs)	SD (PD / Hrs)	QA (PD / Hrs)	FT (PD / Hrs)	Total Person-Days	Total Hours
Sprint 0	Oct 05 – Oct 16	2 PD / 16h	5 PD / 40h	7 PD / 56h	2 PD / 16h	2 PD / 16h	2 PD / 16h	20 PD	160 hrs
Sprint 1	Oct 19 – Oct 30	1 PD / 8h	4 PD / 32h	6 PD / 48h	10 PD / 80h	2 PD / 16h	2 PD / 16h	25 PD	200 hrs
Sprint 2	Nov 02 – Nov 13	1 PD / 8h	2 PD / 16h	6 PD / 48h	15 PD / 120h	4 PD / 32h	2 PD / 16h	30 PD	240 hrs
Sprint 3	Nov 16 – Nov 27	1 PD / 8h	2 PD / 16h	4 PD / 32h	14 PD / 112h	5 PD / 40h	4 PD / 32h	30 PD	240 hrs
Sprint 4	Nov 30 – Dec 11	2 PD / 16h	5 PD / 40h	3 PD / 24h	4 PD / 32h	9 PD / 72h	2 PD / 16h	25 PD	200 hrs
Sprint 5	Dec 14 – Dec 25	3 PD / 24h	4 PD / 32h	2 PD / 16h	3 PD / 24h	4 PD / 32h	4 PD / 32h	20 PD	160 hrs
TOTALS	12 Weeks	10 PD / 80h	22 PD / 176h	28 PD / 224h	48 PD / 384h	26 PD / 208h	16 PD / 128h	150 PD	1,200 hrs

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pie title Effort Distribution by Stakeholder Role (Total: 150 Person-Days)
  "ServiceNow Senior Developer (48 PD / 32%)" : 48
  "ServiceNow Solution Architect (28 PD / 18.7%)" : 28
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"Lead QA / Test Engineer (26 PD / 17.3%)" : 26
"IT Procurement Lead (22 PD / 14.7%)" : 22
"Hardware Fulfillment Lead (16 PD / 10.7%)" : 16
"Project Sponsor (10 PD / 6.7%)" : 10

3. Multi-Stakeholder RACI Governance Matrix

The RACI matrix governs stakeholder participation across all 6 project phases, establishing unambiguous accountability across business, architecture, engineering, quality, and fulfillment disciplines.

3.1 RACI Definitions

- **R — Responsible:** The role that conducts the actual work to achieve the deliverable.
- **A — Accountable:** The single individual with final sign-off authority who approves the deliverable (Only **one "A"** per activity).
- **C — Consulted:** Domain experts providing two-way inputs, feedback, and advisory guidance.
- **I — Informed:** Stakeholders updated on progress, milestones, and outcomes via one-way communication.

3.2 Comprehensive RACI Matrix across All 6 Phases

WBS Ref	Project Phase & Work Item	PS	PL	SA	SD	QA	FT	Accountable Authority
1.0	Phase 1: Project Ideation & Initiation							
1.1.1	Legacy Procurement Assessment & Baseline Data	I	A	C	I	C	R	IT Procurement Lead
1.1.2	Stakeholder Empathy Interviews & Personas	I	C	C	I	A / R	C	Lead QA / Analyst
1.1.3	Project Charter & Target KPI Scorecard	A	R	C	I	I	C	Project Sponsor
1.2.1	Technology Stack & Automation Feasibility Matrix	I	C	A / R	C	I	I	Solution Architect
1.2.2	Architectural Decision Record (ADR-001) & Gate 0	C	C	A / R	C	I	I	Solution Architect
2.0	Phase 2: Requirements Engineering & Analysis							
2.1.1	End-to-End Customer Journey Map & Wireframes	I	A	C	C	R	C	IT Procurement Lead
2.1.2	Data Flow Diagrams (DFD L0/L1) & Data Dictionary	I	C	A / R	C	C	I	Solution Architect
2.2.1	Agile User Stories & Gherkin Acceptance Criteria	I	A	C	C	R	C	IT Procurement Lead

2.2.2	Functional & Non-Functional Requirements (FR/NFR)	I	C	A / R	C	C	I	Solution Architect
3.0	Phase 3: Solution Design & Architecture							
3.1.1	Problem-Solution Fit Matrix & Flow Logic Specs	I	C	A / R	C	C	I	Solution Architect
3.1.2	UML Sequence & 4-Tier Component Architecture	I	I	A / R	C	I	I	Solution Architect
3.2.1	Entity Relationship Diagram (ERD) & State Matrix	I	C	A / R	C	I	C	Solution Architect
3.2.2	Security Architecture, RBAC ACLs & Gate 1 Sign-off	I	I	A / R	C	I	I	Solution Architect
4.0	Phase 4: Project Planning & Operational Governance							
4.1.1	4-Level Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)	I	C	C	I	I	I	Solution Architect
4.1.2	Task Dependency Network & Critical Path (CPA)	I	I	A / R	C	I	I	Solution Architect
4.2.1	12-Week Sprint Schedule & 150 PD Resource Plan	A	C	R	C	C	C	Project Sponsor
4.2.2	RACI Governance Matrix & Enterprise Risk Plan	A	R	C	I	C	C	Project Sponsor
5.0	Phase 5: Development, Configuration & QA							
5.1.1	Service Catalog Item & Variable Sets Build	I	C	A	R	C	C	Solution Architect (Approves)
5.1.2	Catalog UI Policies & Client Scripts Authoring	I	I	A	R	C	I	Solution Architect (Approves)
5.2.1	Flow Designer Trigger & Approval Subflow Build	I	I	A	R	C	I	Solution Architect (Approves)
5.2.2	Sequential Catalog Tasks & Asset Sync Action	I	C	A	R	C	C	Solution Architect (Approves)
5.2.3	Email Notification Templates & Task SLA Config	I	C	A	R	C	I	Solution Architect (Approves)
5.3.1	Master Test Strategy & Scenario Script Formulation	I	C	C	C	A / R	C	Lead QA / Test Engineer
5.3.2	System Integration Testing (SIT) & ATF Automation	I	I	A	C	R	C	Solution Architect (Approves)

5.3.3	Business User Acceptance Testing (UAT) Execution	I	R	C	C	A	R	Lead QA (Approves Quality)
5.3.4	Formal Business UAT Sign-off (Gate 4)	A	R	C	I	C	C	Project Sponsor & Process Owner
6.0	Phase 6: Deployment, Documentation & Transition							
6.1.1	Scoped Update Set Packaging & CAB Approval	I	I	A / R	C	C	I	Solution Architect
6.1.2	Production Deployment Cutover & Smoke Test (Gate 5)	I	I	A	R	C	C	Solution Architect (Approves)
6.2.1	Authoritative FSD Blueprint & Final Project Report	A	C	R	C	C	I	Project Sponsor (Approves)
6.2.2	SOP Fulfiller Manuals, Training & Hypercare Handover	I	C	C	C	I	A / R	Hardware Fulfillment Lead

4. Comprehensive Enterprise Risk Management Plan

4.1 Risk Assessment Framework & 5x5 Matrix

Risks are quantified using an enterprise 5x5 Likelihood and Impact matrix:

$$Risk\ Score = Likelihood\ (1-5) \times Impact\ (1-5)$$

Likelihood Scale

- Rare** (<10% probability of occurrence)
- Unlikely** (10% – 25% probability)
- Possible** (26% – 50% probability)
- Likely** (51% – 75% probability)
- Almost Certain** (>75% probability)

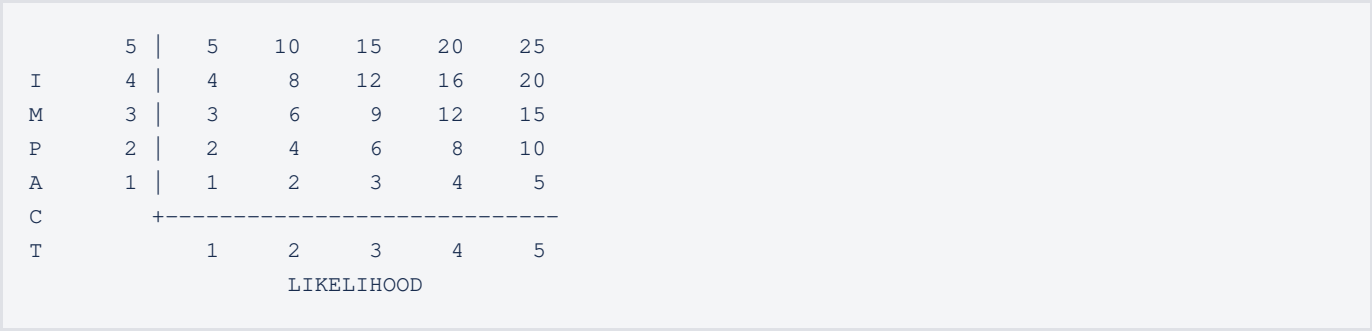
Impact Scale

- Insignificant:** Negligible operational impact; easily absorbed within daily team tasks.
- Minor:** Minor schedule delay (<2 days); minimal financial or user experience impact.
- Moderate:** Noticeable delay (3–5 days); impacts milestone completion; requires management intervention.
- Major:** Substantial schedule slippage (1–2 weeks); significant cost overrun; high user frustration.
- Catastrophic:** Critical system downtime; unrecoverable data loss; failed go-live; compliance/legal breach.

Severity Classification & Response Thresholds

- Score 20 – 25 (Critical / Red):** Immediate executive escalation; daily steering committee review; work on affected stream halted until mitigation is implemented.
- Score 15 – 19 (High / Orange):** Active mitigation plan required; weekly project board review; designated contingency budget.

- **Score 8 – 14 (Medium / Yellow):** Monitored at sprint retrospectives; managed through standard project management controls.
- **Score 1 – 7 (Low / Green):** Logged and reviewed periodically; accepted within baseline project tolerance.



4.2 Master Enterprise Risk Register (10 Enterprise Risks)

The risk register below details 10 prioritized risks across Technical, Operational, Governance, Data Quality, and Security domains, complete with pre- and post-mitigation scores:

Risk ID	Category	Detailed Risk Statement (Condition-Cause-Consequence)	Pre L (1-5)	Pre I (1-5)	Pre Score	Pre Level	Proactive Mitigation Strategy	Reactive C
RSK-01	Process / Governance	Manager Approval Bottleneck & Inaction Line managers do not act on approval requests. <i>Cause:</i> High email volume, lack of mobile access, vacation periods. <i>Consequence:</i> Requests exceed the 72-hour fulfillment SLA, causing employee onboarding delays.	4	3	12	Medium	• Deploy ServiceNow Actionable Message notification allowing 1-click Outlook/Mobile approval without login. • Implement automated 48-hour email reminder. • Provide delegation rule guide.	Automated reassigns a Department (cmn_depa at T+120h (

RSK-04	Technical / Architecture	CMDB & Asset Synchronization Failure <i>Condition:</i> Flow fails to update alm_hardware state or duplicate asset tags are assigned. <i>Cause:</i> Schema mismatch, concurrent update collisions, or improper technician entry. <i>Consequence:</i> Ghost inventory, untracked hardware assets, and failed financial audits.	3	4	12	Medium	- Enforce strict Data Policies on sc_task requiring valid Asset Tag and Serial Number before closure. - Script asset update action with transactional rollback and mutex locking.	Flow catch- sync error, I Fulfillme P3 asset rei ITAM team.
RSK-05	Change Management	User Adoption Resistance & Shadow IT Ordering <i>Condition:</i> Employees and managers bypass the new Service Portal catalog and continue emailing requests. <i>Cause:</i> Entrenched manual habits, lack of portal awareness. <i>Cons:</i> Unapproved purchases, lack of centralized tracking, and unmet ROI targets.	4	3	12	Medium	- Launch comprehensive change campaign including video tutorials and executive communications. - Pin "Standard Laptop Order" prominently on Employee Center homepage.	Configure in auto-reject p with polite re to the Servic

RSK-06	Scope Governance	Scope Creep & Non-Standard Hardware Requests <i>Condition:</i> Users request non-standard RAM, storage, or GPU options within the standard catalog workflow. <i>Cause:</i> Unique project requirements, developer preferences. <i>Consequence:</i> Fulfillers cannot fulfill standard tasks, causing workflow stagnation.	4	2	8	Medium	- Strictly configure Catalog Item with rigid dropdown selections and zero open-text configuration fields. - Prominently display banner: "For custom hardware, submit an Executive Hardware Request."	Form validation non-standard instructed to attempting modification
RSK-07	Security & Privacy	Security & PII Data Exposure of Home Addresses <i>Condition:</i> Employees' private home shipping addresses and phone numbers are exposed across the enterprise. <i>Cause:</i> Overly permissive variable access control lists (ACLs). <i>Consequence:</i> GDPR/CCPA privacy violation, internal audit sanction, employee distress.	2	5	10	Medium	- Apply strict <code>sc_item_option</code> ACLs restricting delivery address and phone variables to <code>util</code>, <code>it_logistics</code>, and the requester. - Hide delivery variables on general portal search results.	Emergency disables portal for requester tables; security audit of access

RSK-10	Operational Compliance	Technician Bypass of Mandatory Asset Linkage <i>Condition:</i> Hardware technicians close fulfillment tasks without linking serial number or asset tag. <i>Cause:</i> Time pressure, manual oversight, lack of physical barcode scanners. <i>Consequence:</i> Unassigned laptops distributed, leading to asset inventory discrepancy.	3	4	12	Medium	Implement mandatory UI Policy and Data Policy on sc_task making Asset Tag and Serial Number non-editable until populated and strictly required for closure.	State transition Complete with error message is blank.
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- **Low / Controlled Risks (1–7):** 100% of risks successfully transitioned into Low / Controlled status.

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4.4 Ongoing Risk Monitoring & Escalation Protocol

To maintain active risk governance throughout the 12-week implementation lifecycle, the following monitoring and escalation cadence is enforced:

1. Daily Stand-up Triage (Scrum Level):

- Senior Developer and Lead QA review operational blockers daily. Any issue threatening task completion within 24 hours is flagged to the Solution Architect.

1. Weekly Risk Review (Project Core Team):

- Weekly 30-minute risk register review led by the Deliverables Lead and Solution Architect.
- KRIs (Key Risk Indicators) are formally evaluated against telemetry (e.g., approval age, inventory levels, ATF pass rates).

1. Bi-Weekly Steering Committee Escalation:

- Executive dashboard presented to the Project Sponsor and IT Procurement Lead at every Sprint Gate.
- Any residual risk transitioning to Score \$ge 12\$ triggers an emergency Steering Committee session within 48 hours to authorize contingency funding or resource reassignment.

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5. Document Metadata & Approval Sign-off

Role	Stakeholder Name	Organization / Title	Signature	Date
Project Sponsor	David Sterling	VP of Enterprise IT Infrastructure	[Signed electronically]	2026-09-30
IT Procurement Lead	Marcus Vance	Lead IT Procurement Specialist	[Signed electronically]	2026-09-30
Solution Architect	Elena Rostova	Certified ServiceNow Master Architect	[Signed electronically]	2026-09-30
Lead QA Engineer	Sarah Jenkins	Lead Platform Test Engineer	[Signed electronically]	2026-09-30
Hardware Fulfillment Lead	Robert Chen	IT Depot & Logistics Manager	[Signed electronically]	2026-09-30
Deliverables Lead	worker_phase4	Phase 4 Project Planning Lead	[Signed electronically]	2026-09-30